

History of English Literature - Important MCQs (Part 4)

Page 19 - English Literature Before Chaucer (Part 3)

Q1. Apart from Beowulf, who are the most important surviving examples of the oldest English poetry?

- A. Chaucer and Shakespeare
- B. Caedmon and Cynewulf
- C. King Alfred and Bede
- D. Layamon and Orm

Answer: B

Q2. When did the conversion of the Anglo-Saxons to Christianity begin?

- A. At the end of the sixth century
- B. At the end of the eighth century
- C. During the Norman Conquest
- D. In the fifth century

Answer: A

Q3. What was Caedmon's occupation before receiving the gift of poetry?

- A. A wandering gleeman
- B. A servant attached to the monastery of Whitby
- C. A wealthy landowner
- D. A king's counselor

Answer: B

Q4. According to Bede's tale, how did Caedmon receive the power of verse?

- A. Through years of rigorous study
- B. By copying Latin texts
- C. Suddenly as a divine gift in a vision
- D. By listening to other gleemen

Answer: C

Q5. What did the heavenly visitor in Caedmon's vision tell him to sing about?

- A. The beginning of created things
- B. The fall of Rome

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- C. The hero Beowulf
- D. The history of the English people

Answer: A

Q6. Which famous poet is thought to have possibly taken hints from the Genesis attributed to Caedmon?

- A. William Shakespeare
- B. Geoffrey Chaucer
- C. John Milton
- D. Alexander Pope

Answer: C

Q7. What was Cynewulf's lifestyle in his earlier life before his conversion?

- A. A strict monk
- B. A wandering gleeman and a lover of pleasure
- C. A soldier in the King's army
- D. A servant at Whitby

Answer: B

Q8. What caused Cynewulf to dedicate himself to religious themes?

- A. A vision of the cross
- B. A near-death experience in battle
- C. A royal decree
- D. An angel appearing in the stables

Answer: A

Q9. Which of the following is NOT a work included among Cynewulf's poems?

- A. Christ
- B. Elene
- C. Juliana
- D. The Battle of Maldon

Answer: D

Q10. What is the subject of Cynewulf's poem 'Elene'?

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- A. The Incarnation and Last Judgment
- B. A tale of Christian martyrdom
- C. The finding of the true cross by Helena
- D. The exodus from Egypt

Answer: C

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Q1. Despite being sacred in subject, what is Anglo-Saxon poetry full of?

- A. Political satire
- B. Romantic love stories
- C. A love of adventure and fighting
- D. Detailed economic records

Answer: C

Q2. Which poem is mentioned as regular war poetry with a spirited translation by Tennyson?

- A. Beowulf
- B. The Battle of Brunanburh
- C. Christ
- D. Dream of the Rood

Answer: B

Q3. What other fondness is ingrained in the English character and is a striking feature of Anglo-Saxon poetry?

- A. A fondness for the sea
- B. A fondness for the mountains
- C. A fondness for city life
- D. A fondness for farming

Answer: A

Q4. Instead of modern end-rhyme, what did Anglo-Saxon verse primarily employ?

- A. Haiku structure
- B. Iambic pentameter
- C. Blank verse
- D. Beginning rhyme, or alliteration

Answer: D

Q5. In the normal type of Anglo-Saxon verse, how many accented syllables were typically in the first division of the line?

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- A. One
- B. Two
- C. Three
- D. Four

Answer: B

Q6. In which region did Anglo-Saxon poetry flourish most?

- A. The south
- B. The north
- C. East Anglia
- D. Wales

Answer: B

Q7. In which region did Anglo-Saxon prose develop later?

- A. The south
- B. The north
- C. Scotland
- D. Ireland

Answer: A

Q8. Who holds an honorable place as the first to put the vernacular to systematic use in prose?

- A. Venerable Bede
- B. Caedmon
- C. King Alfred
- D. King Stephen

Answer: C

Q9. The Venerable Bede wrote his Latin Ecclesiastical History at Jarrow in which kingdom?

- A. Wessex
- B. Mercia
- C. Northumbria
- D. Kent

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Answer: C

Q10. What is considered the greatest monument of Old English prose?

- A. Beowulf
- B. The Anglo-Saxon Chronicle
- C. Ecclesiastical History
- D. Dream of the Rood

Answer: B

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Page 21 - English Literature Before Chaucer (Part 5)

Q1. What happened to English literature for about a hundred and fifty years after the Norman Conquest?

- A. It reached its golden age
- B. It almost ceased to exist
- C. It became entirely French
- D. It was written exclusively in Latin

Answer: B

Q2. In whose reign did the revival of English literature begin?

- A. King William
- B. King Stephen
- C. King John
- D. King Arthur

Answer: C

Q3. What historical event/document showed that the native population and invaders had been welded into a single people?

- A. The Battle of Hastings
- B. Magna Charta
- C. The Domesday Book
- D. The Crusades

Answer: B

Q4. What event tended to further confirm the growing unity of the English nation?

- A. The loss of the French possessions of the English crown
- B. The invasion of Scotland
- C. The translation of the Bible
- D. The discovery of the New World

Answer: A

Q5. Who completed the enormous poem 'Brut' around 1205?

- A. Geoffrey of Monmouth

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- B. Wace
- C. Layamon
- D. Orm

Answer: C

Q6. What does Layamon's poem 'Brut' primarily contain?

- A. The history of the Roman Empire
- B. The legendary history of ancient Britain
- C. Theological arguments
- D. Rules for religious life

Answer: B

Q7. In Layamon's 'Brut,' which three streams of influence run together?

- A. Celtic, French, and English
- B. Roman, Greek, and Celtic
- C. Norse, German, and French
- D. Welsh, Irish, and Scottish

Answer: A

Q8. What is 'Ormulum,' written around 1215?

- A. A prose treatise for anchoresses
- B. A series of metrical homilies
- C. A legendary history of Britain
- D. A dialogue poem between birds

Answer: B

Q9. What was the purpose of the 'Ancren Riwe'?

- A. To instruct knights in chivalry
- B. To provide guidance for three ladies entering the religious life
- C. To teach Latin grammar
- D. To chronicle the reigns of kings

Answer: B

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Q10. Why is 'The Owl and the Nightingale' historically interesting in its versification?

- A. It perfectly uses Anglo-Saxon alliteration.
- B. It is written completely in blank verse.
- C. It discards alliteration and adopts French end-rhyme.
- D. It is the first poem to use sonnet form.

Answer: C